

LaunchPad — RAG Knowledge Base

AI Consulting Career Profile Archetypes

Profile 1 — AI Strategy Consultant

Role title: AI Strategy Consultant **Also known as:** AI Advisor, AI Business Consultant, Digital Transformation Consultant

What this person does: Works at the intersection of business strategy and AI adoption. Advises C-suite executives on where and how AI can create competitive advantage. Does not build AI systems — defines the vision, prioritises use cases, builds the business case, and oversees implementation from a strategic level. Typically engaged as an external consultant or hired into a Chief AI Officer office.

Typical background: Management consulting, business strategy, corporate finance, or senior operations roles. An MBA is common but not required. What matters is the ability to translate business problems into AI opportunities and communicate credibly with both technical teams and board-level stakeholders.

Key skills: Business case development, stakeholder management, AI use case prioritisation, ROI modelling, change management, executive communication, market analysis.

Industries that hire this profile: Financial services, retail, healthcare, manufacturing, professional services, public sector.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Finance professionals bring ROI rigour and board-level credibility
- Operations managers bring process expertise and change management experience
- Engineers bring technical credibility that most strategy consultants lack
- Healthcare professionals bring regulated-industry expertise increasingly in demand

Typical job titles to search: AI Strategy Consultant, AI Advisor, Head of AI Strategy, Digital Transformation Lead, Chief AI Officer

Salary range (Europe): €70,000 — €140,000 + consulting day rates €800 — €2,000

Profile 2 — AI Transformation Lead

Role title: AI Transformation Lead **Also known as:** AI Change Manager, AI Adoption Lead, Digital Transformation Manager

What this person does: Drives the organisational change required to adopt AI at scale inside a company. While the AI Strategy Consultant defines the vision, the AI Transformation Lead executes it — managing the people, process and cultural change that makes AI stick. Focuses on training employees, redesigning workflows, managing resistance, and measuring adoption.

Typical background: Change management, project management, L&D, HR, or operations. Experience running large transformation programmes is more valuable than technical AI knowledge. Empathy, communication, and organisational navigation are the core competencies.

Key skills: Change management methodologies (Prosci, Kotter), stakeholder engagement, training programme design, KPI definition, project management, internal communications, workshop facilitation.

Industries that hire this profile: Any large organisation undergoing AI adoption — financial services, insurance, manufacturing, retail, logistics, public sector.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- L&D professionals and trainers bring the exact skill set this role demands
- HR professionals bring change management and people expertise
- Project managers bring structured execution discipline
- Academy managers bring programme design and adult learning expertise

Typical job titles to search: AI Transformation Lead, AI Change Manager, Digital Adoption Manager, AI Programme Manager, Head of AI Enablement

Salary range (Europe): €65,000 — €120,000

Profile 3 — AI Product Manager

Role title: AI Product Manager **Also known as:** ML Product Manager, AI Product Owner, Product Manager — AI/ML

What this person does: Owns the roadmap and delivery of AI-powered products. Bridges the gap between data science teams and business stakeholders. Defines what gets built, why, and for whom. Writes product requirements, prioritises features, manages the product backlog, and ensures AI capabilities translate into user value. Does not code but must understand AI capabilities and limitations deeply enough to make credible decisions.

Typical background: Product management, software engineering, UX design, data analysis, or business analysis. Technical fluency is highly valued. Experience with agile methodologies is expected.

Key skills: Product roadmap definition, user story writing, agile/scrum, data literacy, A/B testing, user research, stakeholder communication, prioritisation frameworks (RICE, MoSCoW).

Industries that hire this profile: Tech companies, SaaS providers, fintech, healthtech, automotive, any company building AI-powered products.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Engineers bring technical credibility and the ability to challenge data science teams constructively
- UX designers bring user empathy that many AI PMs lack
- Business analysts bring requirements definition skills that transfer directly
- Domain experts (medical, legal, automotive) are highly valued for regulated-industry AI products

Typical job titles to search: AI Product Manager, ML Product Manager, Product Manager AI, Product Owner — Data & AI

Salary range (Europe): €75,000 — €140,000

Profile 4 — AI Implementation Consultant

Role title: AI Implementation Consultant **Also known as:** AI Solutions Consultant, AI Integration Specialist, Technical AI Consultant

What this person does: Takes AI solutions from selection to deployment inside client organisations. More hands-on than the AI Strategy Consultant — actually configures tools, integrates APIs, builds workflows, and trains end users. Works closely with IT teams and vendors. Often the person who makes n8n workflows, connects OpenAI APIs, and gets systems working in production.

Typical background: IT consulting, systems integration, software development, technical pre-sales, or field application engineering. Comfort with APIs, no-code/low-code tools, and basic scripting is essential.

Key skills: API integration, no-code/low-code tools (n8n, Make, Zapier), prompt engineering, workflow automation, vendor management, technical documentation, user training, troubleshooting.

Industries that hire this profile: Consulting firms, system integrators, technology vendors, any company that needs someone to actually deploy AI tools rather than just advise on them.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Field Application Engineers transition almost perfectly — client-facing, technically deep, comfortable with integration challenges
- IT consultants bring systems integration experience that is directly applicable
- Electronics engineers bring structured problem-solving and technical documentation discipline
- Bootcamp graduates with no-code/low-code skills are increasingly competitive in this role

Typical job titles to search: AI Implementation Consultant, AI Solutions Consultant, AI Integration Specialist, Automation Consultant, No-Code AI Consultant

Salary range (Europe): €60,000 — €110,000 + consulting day rates €600 — €1,500

Profile 5 — AI Compliance & Ethics Consultant

Role title: AI Compliance & Ethics Consultant **Also known as:** AI Risk Consultant, Responsible AI Consultant, AI Governance Advisor

What this person does: Helps organisations navigate the legal, ethical, and regulatory requirements of deploying AI — particularly in Europe under the EU AI Act and GDPR. Conducts risk assessments, classifies AI systems, writes compliance documentation, advises on data governance, and ensures AI deployments meet regulatory obligations. Demand for this profile is accelerating rapidly as EU AI Act enforcement begins.

Typical background: Legal, compliance, risk management, data protection, policy, or any technical field with regulatory exposure. Understanding of EU AI Act and GDPR is essential. Technical background is a strong differentiator — most compliance professionals lack it.

Key skills: EU AI Act classification, GDPR compliance, DPIA writing, risk assessment, technical documentation, data governance, legal interpretation, stakeholder advisory, audit preparation.

Industries that hire this profile: Financial services, healthcare, automotive, public sector, any regulated industry deploying AI, consulting firms building AI compliance practices.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Legal and compliance professionals bring regulatory expertise but often lack technical depth

- Engineers bring technical credibility that makes compliance arguments far more robust — a rare and highly valued combination
- Automotive safety professionals bring ISO/functional safety experience that maps directly to AI risk assessment methodology
- Data protection officers bring GDPR expertise that is a core component of this role

Typical job titles to search: AI Compliance Consultant, AI Risk Consultant, Responsible AI Lead, AI Governance Advisor, EU AI Act Consultant

Salary range (Europe): €70,000 — €130,000 + consulting day rates €800 — €2,000

Profile 6 — AI Trainer & Enablement Specialist

Role title: AI Trainer & Enablement Specialist **Also known as:** AI Learning Specialist, AI Adoption Trainer, AI Upskilling Consultant

What this person does: Designs and delivers training programmes that help organisations and individuals use AI tools effectively. Creates learning content, runs workshops, coaches individuals, and measures training effectiveness. As AI adoption accelerates, demand for people who can make AI accessible to non-technical audiences is growing rapidly.

Typical background: L&D, instructional design, corporate training, teaching, coaching, or any role involving knowledge transfer. Domain expertise in a specific field (finance, healthcare, law, engineering) combined with AI knowledge is a powerful differentiator.

Key skills: Curriculum design, instructional design, workshop facilitation, adult learning principles, LMS platforms, content creation, coaching, assessment design, stakeholder communication.

Industries that hire this profile: Bootcamps, corporate L&D departments, consulting firms, technology vendors, any organisation scaling AI adoption internally.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Teachers and educators transition almost perfectly — adult learning is their core competency
- Corporate trainers and L&D professionals bring programme design and facilitation skills
- Academy managers bring end-to-end programme ownership experience
- Domain experts who can train AI in the context of their former industry (medical AI training, legal AI training) command premium rates

Typical job titles to search: AI Trainer, AI Learning Specialist, AI Enablement Consultant, AI Upskilling Lead, Corporate AI Coach

Salary range (Europe): €50,000 — €95,000 + training day rates €800 — €1,800

Profile 7 — Freelance AI Consultant

Role title: Freelance AI Consultant **Also known as:** Independent AI Advisor, AI Contractor, AI Fractional Consultant

What this person does: Works independently across multiple clients, offering AI consulting services on a project or retainer basis. May specialise in a specific industry vertical, a specific AI capability (prompt engineering, RAG systems, automation), or a specific business function (marketing AI, HR AI, operations AI). Maximum flexibility, maximum self-direction, variable income. Typically builds a personal brand through content, speaking, or network referrals.

Typical background: Any professional background combined with AI skills and entrepreneurial appetite. Prior consulting or client-facing experience accelerates success significantly. Domain specialisation is the primary differentiator — generalist freelance AI consultants face more competition than specialists.

Key skills: Client acquisition, proposal writing, project scoping, independent delivery, personal branding, networking, financial management, specialised AI capability in at least one domain.

Industries that hire this profile: SMEs that cannot afford full-time AI staff, startups, scale-ups, any organisation needing project-based AI expertise.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Any deep domain expert becomes a specialist AI consultant for their former industry
- Client-facing professionals (sales engineers, FAEs, account managers) already know how to manage client relationships independently
- Technical professionals with communication skills are rare and command premium freelance rates
- People with existing professional networks can bootstrap a freelance practice faster than those starting from zero

Typical platforms and channels: Toptal, Upwork (enterprise tier), Malt, direct network referrals, LinkedIn content strategy

Day rate range (Europe): €600 — €2,500 depending on specialisation and seniority

Profile 8 — AI Product Owner / Venture Builder

Role title: AI Venture Builder / AI Startup Founder **Also known as:** AI Entrepreneur, AI Product Creator, Founding AI Consultant

What this person does: Builds AI-powered products or ventures from scratch — either as a founder, as an early employee at an AI startup, or as an intrapreneur within a larger organisation. Combines product thinking, AI capability, and business development. Higher risk, higher reward. This path suits people who identified a specific problem in their former industry that AI can solve and want to own the solution rather than consult on it.

Typical background: Any background, but domain expertise in a specific industry is critical — the venture must solve a real problem the founder understands deeply. Prior startup experience or intrapreneurship is advantageous but not required. Comfort with ambiguity and resourcefulness are essential.

Key skills: Problem identification, MVP building, fundraising or bootstrapping, go-to-market strategy, product development, team building, investor communication, resilience.

Industries: Any — the best AI ventures come from founders who identify underserved problems in industries they know deeply.

Transition edge — what prior careers bring:

- Deep domain experts see problems that outsiders miss — this is the single biggest advantage
- Engineers bring the technical credibility to build or direct technical co-founders
- Training and L&D professionals often identify knowledge transfer problems that scale well as SaaS products
- Safety and compliance professionals see regulatory gaps that become defensible product moats

Typical entry points: Accelerators (Y Combinator, Antler, Entrepreneur First), venture studios, building alongside consulting work, internal innovation programmes

Equity upside: Unlimited — this is the highest risk, highest reward path on this list